Integrated Postal Architecture
Philipa Philatelic Management

Precision Postal Software Design



The Philatelic Management module of the Integrated Postal Architecture (IPA) is known by the product name of *PHILIPA* and is designated by the use of the *PHILIPA* logo. *PHILIPA* is designed to meet the needs of all philatelic agencies and is scaleable for small and large organizations.

Overview

The Philatelic Management System is a set of core functionality designed in a flexible and extensible architecture that is tailored to meet the needs of an individual post office.

Having been designed from initial concepts with the flexibility to suit the requirements of many post offices, great attention has been paid to the need for an open architecture and the ability to quickly change the functionality of the system.

Both the user interface and the underlying database can be operated in multiple languages including right anchored languages such as Arabic/Farsi/Urdu and symbolic languages such as Chinese and Japanese. As it is quite common for philatelic departments to store information regarding overseas customers and be paid in foreign currencies, the system is designed to accept all character sets and currencies and to perform automatic currency conversions/accounting.

Payments can be accepted in many forms including cash, cheque, bankers draft, money order etc. and held in a clearing account prior to acceptance as payment to an account. The system also manages credit customers and will produce invoices/ statements for individual or corporate customers.

As all systems within the IPA are fully integrated, if the *CORVUS* branch automation system is in use, account payments can be accepted at any post office branch and remittances to/from post office departments/branches can be achieved electronically including branch philatelic departments.

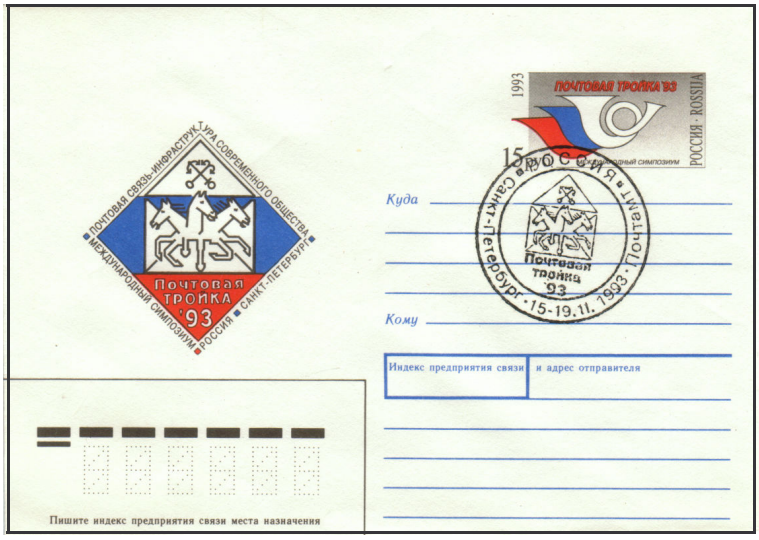
The data contained in the system can be input and output to other systems via ASCII Comma separated text or XML or directly to 3rd party databases.



The philatelic management system can by used to generate the HTML pages of a web catalogue that is fully up to date with all your current issues. The format of the HTML can be customized to fit in with your current e-commerce system if you have one. This catalogue can also be printed or used in mail shots.

Customers can be added to various subscription levels within the system and be automatically notified of or issued with new releases.

The system can also be interfaced with Microsoft office for mail shots and automatic email newsletters.





IPA = Cost-effective, Flexible, Integrated Solutions for the Postal Industry



Account Management

The account management within *PHILIPA* allows for all your domestic and overseas customers details and preferences to be collected and searched. Information about a customer's subscription levels, preferences, various addresses, renewal dates, current balance and full statement details are available. Both Credit and Debit customers are catered for and the automatic generation of statements and invoices can be customized to fit your current and future requirements.

Stock Management

All philatelic stock (and Aerogrammes, IRC's NVI's PDL's etc. if required) can be managed within the philatelic system. Stock can be issued/returned to/ from post office branches, stamp vendors, bulk buyers, printers, dealers etc. new stock items/issues/ styles can be easily added with full details and pictures. This information can be distributed to other philatelic outlets and managed electronically, including views of all stock held within the post office organization.

Each philatelic outlet (or *CORVUS* branch if installed) can be assigned Maximum, Minimum and Nominal stock levels of each item within the inventory. This way, an outlet can automatically order their stock on a daily basis and maintain their stock at nominal levels. The outlets will be prevented from "hoarding" and will be warned if the levels of a particular item fall below minimum levels.

When new inventory items arrive they can be added to the system and automatically issued to the outlets, grouped by clients and notified to interested parties via email.

Inventory items can be grouped into:

Definitive Stamps, Commemorative Stamps, Gutter Pairs, Sheets, Reprints/Reissues, Full Sheets, Miniature sheets, Booklets, Limited Edition Prints, Year Books, Year Packs, Presentation Packs, First Day Covers, Non Value Indicators, Maxicards, Postcards, Aerogrammes, Various Non-Value Forms or any other grouping that you may require.

Stock Sold or issued to other parties can be discounted in various ways to handle Vendors, Dealers etc. These adjustments can be applied as discounts or commissions and multiple discounts can be applied to different groups.

Various Summary and Detailed Stock and Sales reports for Departmental Management can be printed from the system including Stock levels and discounts / commissions applied to sales.

Supplier accounts can also be added to the system for use when remitting new stock or returning stock.

If you are using the *CORVUS* Branch Automation system, or have separate philatelic departments in your post office branches, you can also accept account payments/orders via your retail network.

As overseas customers will hold many of your accounts, the payments received will often be in foreign currencies or by cheque/draft. The accounting system allows for currency exchange and loss/gain on exchange calculations including any commissions due, and for placing payments in a holding account pending clearance.

Renewal Notices, Reminders and Marketing information can be generated for sending to your customers (or sub-sets) and can be customized to suit your current and future needs. *PHILIPA* can interface directly with Microsoft Office or these details can be exported via CSV or XML or customized to suit your legacy system requirements.



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